

Rural India can lead the biodiversity revolution

With its rich **biodiversity**, **deep-rooted** farming traditions, and a population that still lives close to the land, rural India **holds the key** to reversing India's biodiversity crisis and achieving true **sustainable development**. As the world observes International Day for Biological Diversity (IDB), the **spotlight** turns toward the communities that have long lived in **harmony** with nature and the urgent need to **empower** them as agents of **ecological** change.

As we near the 2030 deadline for the Sustainable Development Goals and the Kunming-Montreal Global Biodiversity Framework (KMGBF), it becomes increasingly clear that rural India is not only central to India's biodiversity **agenda** — it could well be the **catalyst** that **tips the scales**.

Biodiversity is far more than an environmental concern; it is the foundation of life. It supports our food systems, **sustains livelihoods**, regulates the climate, purifies water, and provides protection against natural disasters. The **rapid loss** of species and **ecosystems**, both globally and in India, **is** not just a tragedy for nature — it is a threat to human survival and well-being. The KMGBF **calls for** a global transformation: a new way of living that restores the balance between people and the natural world. In India, this transformation is most possible and most needed in our villages and agricultural farmlands. The **legacy** of the Green Revolution, while **pivotal in addressing** food shortages in post-independence India, also **set** farmers on a path heavily **reliant on** chemical fertilisers, pesticides, **monoculture** crops, and **genetically modified seeds**. Over time, this model has **led to soil degradation**, declining biodiversity, water stress, and increased input costs — leaving many smallholders **vulnerable**. As the ecological costs of this type of farming become more **evident**, the **need of the hour** is to re-educate and enable farmers helping them reconnect with time-tested traditional methods that work with nature, not against it. Natural farming, agroecology, and organic techniques offer a path toward regeneration. And it's not a case of 'easier said than done. Rural India is home to nearly two-thirds of the country's population and the majority of its agricultural production. For centuries, Indian farmers and **indigenous** communities have worked with, rather than against, nature. They've practised traditional farming systems that **nurture** biodiversity-rotating crops, saving seeds, maintaining mixed farming systems, and using organic inputs long before they were branded as "sustainable." These time-tested approaches offer valuable solutions to today's challenges — if only we can help our farmers remember them and adopt them.

By building on these traditions and expanding nature-friendly practices like agroecology, organic farming, and natural farming, India can move toward a truly sustainable agri-food system—one that supports biodiversity instead of **depleting** it. And yet, this **transition** requires more than just technical changes. It demands a shift in how we value and support rural communities. Farmers must be recognised not only as food producers but as **stewards** of biodiversity. Their knowledge must be respected, their leadership encouraged, and their work made economically **viable**.

This moment also calls for greater **synergy** between policy and practice. India's National Biodiversity Strategies and Action Plans have an opportunity to meaningfully integrate the **ambitious** targets of the Kunming-Montreal Global Biodiversity Framework (KMGBF) while **aligning with** national and state-level development priorities. Government support will continue to play a crucial role-through enabling policies, incentives, training, and infrastructure. Just as vital, however, is the active engagement of civil society, CSR bodies, local institutions, and farmers themselves, who bring invaluable on-ground experience and **insight**. By working together across sectors, we can co-create solutions that are both locally rooted and globally relevant.

As the 2030 deadline **looms**, the **need** for action **is** urgent. But there is still time to rewrite the story. The International Day for Biological Diversity reminds us to recognise that India's future **lies** not in **distant** boardrooms or global summits-but in its villages, fields, and forests. Here, **harmony** with nature **is** a way of life-waiting to be recognised, **revitalised**, and **scaled** for a better tomorrow.

- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where 'red' denotes 'subject' and 'blue' denotes 'verb'.

Vocabulary

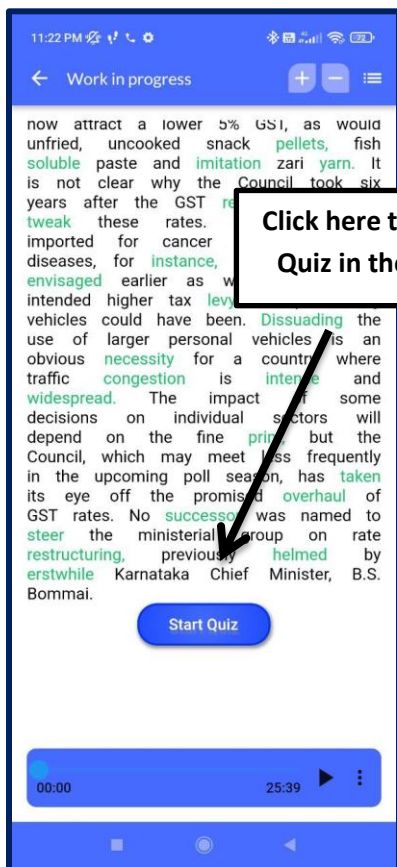
1. **Biodiversity** (noun) – variety of life, species richness, ecological diversity, biological variety, ecosystem variation जैव विविधता
2. **Deep-rooted** (adjective) – ingrained, entrenched, established, fixed, firm गहराई से जड़ी हुई
3. **Hold the key** (phrase) – be crucial, be essential, be vital, be central, unlock the solution प्रमुख होना / समाधान देना
4. **Sustainable development** (noun) – development that meets the needs of the present without compromising the ability of future generations to meet their own needs सतत विकास
5. **Spotlight** (noun) – focus, attention, limelight, prominence, highlight प्रकाश में / ध्यान केंद्रित करना
6. **Harmony** (noun) – balance, peace, accord, unity, synchrony सद्भाव
7. **Empower** (verb) – enable, authorize, strengthen, equip, support सशक्त बनाना
8. **Ecological** (adjective) – environmental, green, eco-friendly, biological, nature-based पारिस्थितिकीय
9. **Agenda** (noun) – plan, schedule, program, scheme, objective कार्यसूची
10. **Catalyst** (noun) – trigger, accelerator, stimulus, spark, enabler उत्प्रेरक
11. **Tip the scale** (phrase) – change the balance, influence outcome, turn the tide, sway, alter the situation संतुलन बदलना
12. **Sustain** (verb) – maintain, uphold, support, continue, preserve बनाए रखना
13. **Livelihood** (noun) – income, living, sustenance, means of support, occupation आजीविका
14. **Rapid** (adjective) – fast, swift, quick, sudden, accelerated तीव्र
15. **Ecosystem** (noun) – environment, habitat, ecological system, biome, natural system पारिस्थितिकी तंत्र
16. **Call for** (phrasal verb) – demand, require, necessitate, urge, appeal मांग करना
17. **Legacy** (noun) – heritage, inheritance, tradition, outcome, remnant विरासत
18. **Pivotal** (in) (adjective) – crucial, key, essential, central, significant अत्यंत महत्वपूर्ण
19. **Address** (verb) – tackle, deal with, resolve, confront, respond to समाधान करना
20. **Reliant** (on) (adjective) – dependent, trusting, conditioned, hooked, reliant निर्भर
21. **Monoculture** (noun) – the cultivation of a single crop in a given area.

22. **Genetically modified seed** (noun) – seeds that have been altered in their DNA using genetic engineering techniques to produce specific traits.
23. **Lead** (to) (verb) – result in, cause, bring about, contribute to, produce कारण बनना
24. **Soil degradation** (noun) – the decline in soil quality and its ability to support plant growth, ecosystem services, and overall health.
25. **Vulnerable** (adjective) – exposed, at risk, fragile, weak, unsafe असुरक्षित
26. **Evident** (adjective) – clear, obvious, apparent, visible, noticeable स्पष्ट
27. **The need of the hour** (phrase) – urgent necessity, current requirement, present demand, crucial need, pressing issue समय की आवश्यकता
28. **Indigenous** (adjective) – native, local, original, tribal, aboriginal स्वदेशी
29. **Nurture** (verb) – cultivate, foster, nourish, develop, care for बढ़ावा देना
30. **Deplete** (verb) – exhaust, reduce, drain, diminish, use up समाप्त करना / घटाना
31. **Transition** (noun) – shift, change, transformation, evolution, movement परिवर्तन
32. **Steward** (noun) – caretaker, guardian, manager, protector, conservator संरक्षक
33. **Viable** (adjective) – feasible, workable, practical, sustainable, achievable व्यावहारिक
34. **Synergy** (noun) – cooperation, collaboration, partnership, alliance, combined effort तालमेल
35. **Ambitious** (adjective) – aspirational, determined, bold, enterprising, goal-oriented महत्वाकांक्षी
36. **Align** (with) (verb) – match, coordinate, harmonize, conform, synchronize मेल खाना / अनुकूल होना
37. **Insight** (noun) – understanding, perception, awareness, comprehension, observation अंतर्दृष्टि
38. **Loom** (verb) – approach, emerge, appear, threaten, hover मंडराना
39. **Lie** (verb) – exist, rest, reside, dwell, be situated स्थित होना
40. **Distant** (adjective) – faraway, remote, far-off, removed, detached दूरस्थ
41. **Revitalise** (verb) – renew, refresh, energize, rejuvenate, restore पुनर्जीवित करना
42. **Scale** (verb) – expand, grow, enlarge, increase, multiply बढ़ाना / विस्तार करना

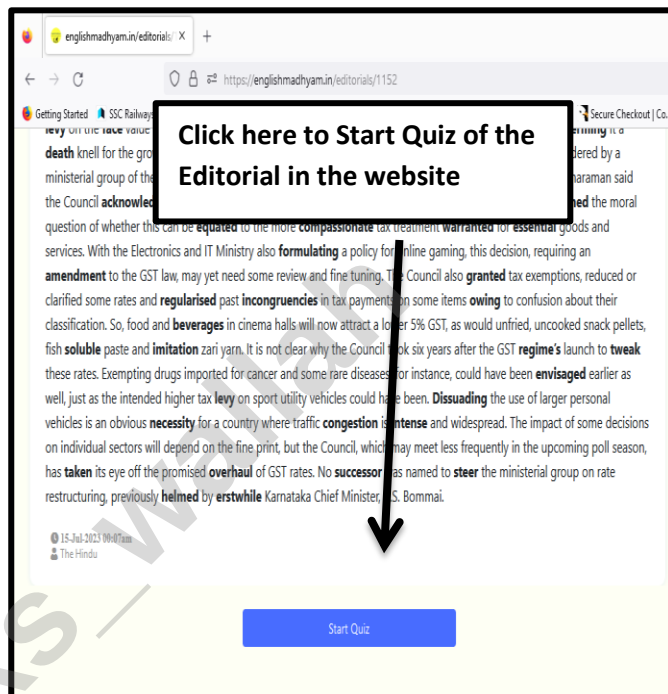
Summary of the Editorial

1. **Rural India's Importance:** With its biodiversity and traditional farming practices, rural India is crucial for reversing India's biodiversity crisis and promoting sustainable development.
2. **Global Context:** As the world marks the International Day for Biological Diversity, there's a renewed focus on empowering rural communities as ecological change-makers.
3. **Biodiversity's Role:** Biodiversity supports food systems, livelihoods, climate regulation, water purification, and disaster protection—making its preservation essential for human survival.
4. **Global Framework:** The Kunming-Montreal Global Biodiversity Framework (KMGBF) calls for transformative change in how humans interact with nature.
5. **Need for Change in India:** India's villages and farmlands are the most viable places for ecological transformation aligned with KMGBF goals.
6. **Impact of the Green Revolution:** While solving food scarcity, the Green Revolution led to harmful ecological impacts, including soil degradation and biodiversity loss.
7. **Reconnecting with Tradition:** Farmers must be re-educated to adopt traditional practices that are nature-aligned, such as natural farming and agroecology.
8. **Sustainable Techniques:** Practices like crop rotation, seed saving, mixed farming, and organic inputs have historically sustained biodiversity.
9. **Rural Capacity:** Nearly two-thirds of Indians live in rural areas, making them central to agricultural production and biodiversity conservation.
10. **Economic Support:** Transitioning to sustainable farming requires making it economically viable and recognising farmers as biodiversity stewards.
11. **Policy Integration:** India's National Biodiversity Strategies should integrate KMGBF goals while aligning with development priorities.
12. **Government Role:** Support through policies, incentives, training, and infrastructure is essential for sustainable transformation.
13. **Multi-Sector Collaboration:** Civil society, CSR bodies, local institutions, and farmers must collaborate to create context-specific, effective solutions.
14. **Urgency for Action:** With the 2030 deadline for SDGs and KMGBF approaching, immediate action is necessary to meet biodiversity targets.
15. **Hope for the Future:** India's path to sustainability lies not in policy alone, but in revitalising traditional ecological wisdom rooted in rural life.

Practice Exercise: Banking Pattern Based



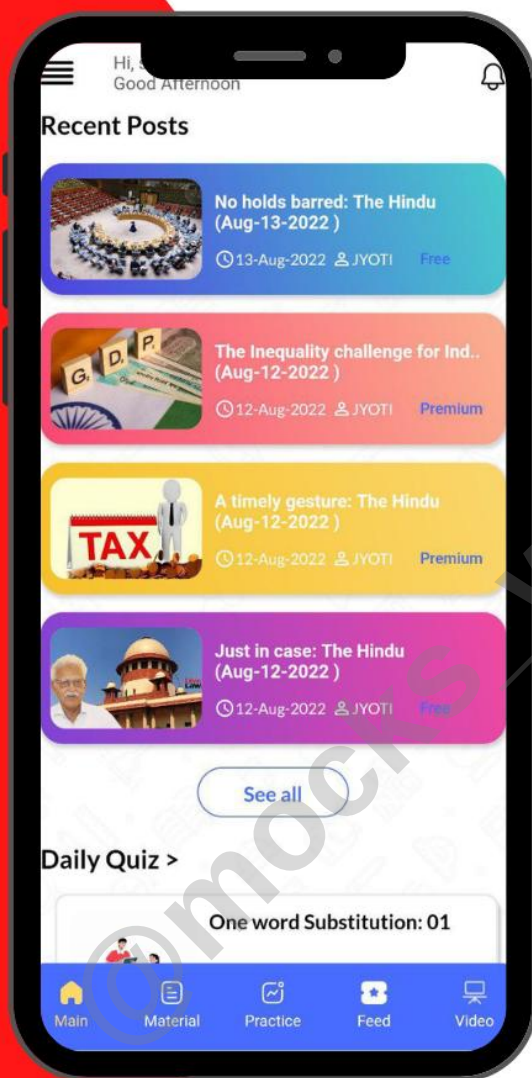
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